A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Food, Beverage and FMCG Import Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so the permits, customs treatment and delivery plan are settled early.

Why Late Compliance Costs You in Food

For food, beverage and FMCG cargo, the cost is rarely the freight. It is a permit, classification or handling requirement discovered after the goods have already shipped. Typical cargo includes processed food, beverages, ingredients, supplements, chilled or frozen goods, alcohol, retail merchandise and consumer products. Mills Permits, Mills Customs and Mills Logistics work together to settle these points before you book.

Use this list before you book. Any box you cannot tick is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- [ ] **1. The product categories are listed**
  List each product by type, such as food, drink, supplement or alcohol, since each can face different rules.
- [ ] **2. FDA requirements are confirmed**
  Confirm the FDA license and product registration needed for your products, and that they are current.
- [ ] **3. Agency permits for animal and plant products are mapped**
  For meat, seafood or plant-based inputs, confirm whether BAI, BPI, BFAR or NMIS permits apply.
- [ ] **4. Excise and BIR rules are checked**
  For alcohol and other excisable goods, confirm the BIR requirements and the excise treatment expected.
- [ ] **5. Labeling meets the rules**
  Check that labels meet FDA and DTI requirements for language, ingredients and product information.
- [ ] **6. Shelf life and expiry are planned**
  Confirm remaining shelf life on arrival, and that the timeline from production to shelf is realistic.
- [ ] **7. Classification and valuation are settled**
  Agree on tariff classification and supporting value documents, and keep them consistent.
- [ ] **8. Cold-chain needs are covered**
  For chilled or frozen goods, confirm the temperature range, equipment and storage on arrival.
- [ ] **9. Packaging is suitable**
  Confirm packaging protects the product and meets labeling and handling needs, including treated wood where used.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- ☐ **10. Inspection and sampling are anticipated**
  Plan for agency inspection or sampling, and keep a contact who can respond quickly.

- ☐ **11. Warehouse and distribution are arranged**
  Confirm storage and delivery to stores or distributors, with the right conditions for each product.

- ☐ **12. Traceability and recall records are kept**
  Keep batch, permit and delivery records together, so a product can be traced if a problem arises.

Importing food and beverage? Let us check it before it ships.

Book a short call and we will review your product, permits and delivery plan before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.